ADMINISTRATION FOR CHILDREN & FAMILIES
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Tribal TANF Sanction Reporting

For vendors supporting Tribal TANF Programs

Why your support is needed

ACF sends Tribal TANF programs feedback reports to identify data quality issues that may affect their work participation rates (WPR). The WPR Errors Report flags sanction-related errors affecting most Tribal TANF programs, so you may see this issue across the programs you support.

Programs have told ACF that their systems may report sanctions for the month of noncompliance instead of when the sanction takes effect. This appears to be related to retrospective budgeting and how case management systems were built. Programs may need your help to correct the data and update how their systems prepare reports.

What the reporting guidance says

For cases that remain active: Report a work sanction in Section 1 for the month the assistance reduction applies. An earlier month of noncompliance does not determine the sanction reporting month.

For cases that close because of a sanction: Use Section 2 for the last month the family received assistance and select the work-related sanction closure reason.

These instructions apply to the Tribal TANF Data Report. They do not prescribe how programs track noncompliance or sanctions internally.

Read the sanction reporting guidance in the Tribal TANF WPR Feedback Guide, pages 22-24. Review the scenarios with your programs before making changes.

Next steps for vendors

1) Review sanction-related errors in each program's WPR Errors Report with that program and compare how your system prepares the data with ACF guidance.

2) Discuss any changes needed to support corrections. Share planned changes and timeframes with your programs so they can keep ACF informed before the next fiscal year's feedback cycle.

3) If you need clarification, get permission from the programs you support and schedule a one-on-one with the ACF data team. At least one supported Tribal TANF program must join the call.

Questions about reporting expectations?

Schedule a 1:1 meeting with the ACF data team. Bring your questions and at least one program you support.
Learn more: Tribal TANF Feedback Reports